

Porter Cook

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GitHub Portfolio: <https://porterrockwell.github.io/>

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Hiring Committee

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to introduce myself and express my interest in opportunities in industrial automation, robotics, and engineering instruction. I am a mechatronic engineer and the Visiting Instructor of Practice for Industrial Robotics at Utah Tech University, where I combine hands-on automation experience from industry with teaching on real equipment.

At Utah Tech I helped develop a new Industrial Robotics curriculum and restructured it to teach static and inertial forces, I/O, and Ethernet communication alongside programming and operation. I was the first instructor to bring FANUC ROBOGUIDE into the course, and I helped develop a PLC trainer that pairs an AutomationDirect P1000 PLC with a FANUC LR Mate 200iD through CRMA58 terminal blocks so students can practice group I/O, digital logic, and PLC-to-robot Ethernet communication. I am also teaching MTRN 2200 and MTRN 2205, implemented the lab safety protocols students follow around the robots, and am pursuing FANUC CERT Instructor Certification through FANUC America.

Before teaching, I worked in industry. As an Automation Engineering Intern at Baxter Aerospace, I developed the HVX high-voltage automated test system for aerospace wire harnesses, integrated PLC control for sensor data collection, programmed Yaskawa, FANUC, and Universal Robots, and built C# WPF applications linked to SQL databases for MES work instructions. At IME Automation I contributed to an automated system project from development through completion. For my senior capstone with Lovesac, I was responsible for the electrical and controls design of a material dispensing system, including the HMI, ladder logic, and panel wiring. I have also completed training through Beckhoff (TwinCAT 3) and FANUC Academy (HandlingTool Operations and Programming).

I bring a practical, safety-first approach, a habit of testing before running, and the ability to explain technical work clearly to students and teammates. I would welcome the chance to discuss how my background could contribute to your team. My CV, references, and teaching philosophy are enclosed, and my portfolio is available at porterrockwell.github.io.

Sincerely,

Porter Cook

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Enclosures: Curriculum Vitae, References, Teaching Philosophy